

PULSEGUARD TECHNOLOGIES INC. - STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE

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Title: SECURITY INCIDENT RESPONSE PROTOCOL
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Classification: Internal Restricted

1. PURPOSE & OBJECTIVE

This document outlines the mandatory procedures for identifying, responding to, and mitigating security and technical incidents within the PulseGuard technical infrastructure. The objective is to minimize downtime, protect sensitive system boundaries, ensure compliance with privacy laws, and recover quickly from unforeseen breaches or hardware faults.

2. SCOPE

This SOP applies to all security incidents, data breaches, key exposures, system outages, and physical breaches impacting the digital infrastructure, networks, cloud environments, or software products of PulseGuard Technologies Inc. It governs all internal engineers, response squads, and support teams.

3. ROLES AND RESPONSIBILITIES

3.1. Incident Commander (IC)

- Takes ownership of the incident log and lifecycle.
- Directs technical mitigation tasks and assigns team duties.
- Documents timelines and corrective actions.

3.2. Chief Security Officer (CSO)

- Receives official alerts for high-risk leaks or compromises.
- Authorizes communications to external clients or regulators.

3.3. Response Engineers

- Investigate technical logs to determine root causes.
- Revoke/rotate keys, deploy hotfixes, and reset configurations.

3.4. VP of Engineering

- Approves major architectural adjustments under incident stress.
- Coordinates resource allocation across engineering departments.

4. DEFINITIONS AND REFERENCES

- Incident: An unplanned disruption or security event affecting infrastructure.
- PII: Personally Identifiable Information (emails, phone numbers, addresses).
- Grade-1 (Critical): Compromise of production systems, databases, active key leaks (AWS keys, database passwords in public repos), or PII exposure.
- Grade-2 (Major): Outage of staging environment or non-critical tools.
- Grade-3 (Minor): Small bugs or UI glitches that do not block operations.
- SOP-ENG-001: Engineering Code Review Protocols (reference document).

5. INCIDENT CLASSIFICATION MATRIX

Incidents must be graded upon detection according to this matrix:

5.1. Grade-1 Incident Criteria:

- Compromise or leak of database configurations.
- Active secret key or credential checked into public GitHub.
- Data breach exposing user data (PII).
- Total production service outage affecting >5% of active users.

5.2. Grade-2 Incident Criteria:

- Staging database failure.
 - CI/CD build system blockages.
 - Internal ticketing or wiki system down.
- 5.3. Grade-3 Incident Criteria:
- Incorrect styling on internal dashboards.
 - Non-blocking console warning logs.
 - Performance degradation under 5%.

6. MANDATORY RESPONSE TIMELINES FOR GRADE-1 CRITICAL LEAKS

If a Grade-1 incident is identified, the following timelines are legally binding:

6.1. Reporting and Notification

- The Chief Security Officer (CSO) must be notified immediately.
- The absolute deadline for CSO notification is 15 minutes from

detection.

6.2. Credential Rotation Window

- If an active API key or AWS secret is leaked to a public repository, the affected credentials must be rotated immediately.
- The mandatory rotation window is 1 hour from the moment of detection.

6.3. Weekend and Holiday Support

- Grade-1 incidents must be handled immediately.
- Incident response is active 24/7/365. Waiting for business hours or

the

weekend to end to rotate keys or report breaches is a severe protocol violation and subject to immediate disciplinary audit.

6.4. Mitigation and Containment

- Isolation of affected servers or networks must happen within 30

minutes.

7. PROCEDURAL STEP-BY-STEP RESPONSE FLOW (GRADE-1 LEAKS)

Step 1: Detection

- Automations or developers identify a public leak of key parameters.

Step 2: Declaration

- Developer declares Grade-1 Incident in the emergency slack channel.

Step 3: Notification

- Incident Commander pages the CSO and VP of Engineering (15 mins max).

Step 4: Containment (Credential Rotation)

- Engineer identifies the exposed key (e.g. AWS).
- Revokes key permissions via the cloud access management panel.
- Generates new key and updates production configurations securely.
- Confirms revocation and updates target PR/branch (1 hour max).

Step 5: Investigation

- Forensic engineers review logs to check if the key was exploited.

Step 6: Resolution

- System is verified clean, and the incident is marked "Resolved".

Step 7: Post-Mortem

- A post-mortem document is compiled within 48 hours to prevent

recurrences.

8. TROUBLESHOOTING & ESCALATION PROCEDURES

8.1. Delayed Credential Rotation

- If rotation is not completed in 1 hour, the ticketing system triggers an automated priority escalation call to the department manager.

8.2. Escalation Contact Path

- First Contact: Department Engineering Lead.
- Second Contact: Sneha Deshmukh (VP of Engineering / Escalation

Manager).

- Executive Escalation: CSO Office (security-alerts@policypulse.dev).

9. REVISION HISTORY LOG

Version	Date	Author	Description of Change
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v1.0		2023-04-12		V. Kulkarni		Initial launch of incident protocol.
v2.0		2024-02-18		V. Kulkarni		Added AWS key rotation schedules.
v3.0		2025-05-10		S. Deshmukh		Extended 24/7 weekend support
requirements.						
v4.1		2026-01-15		V. Kulkarni		Added strict 15-minute notification
rules.						
